

Plan C

Game Design Document

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1. Game Overview

Genre: **Mystery, Psychological Horror**

Target Audience: fans of choice-driven visual novels and mystery cases

Age Rating: 10+

1.1. Introduction

Plan C is a **2D first person interactive fiction mystery** game for web browser, *Linux* and *Windows* PC where the player takes the role of a **detective** working on a case of people going missing, when suddenly he **loses consciousness** and wakes up in an **unfamiliar bedroom** with a **stranger** where he **has to escape from**.

The game follows a **non-linear story** that develops through the **interaction** between characters and the player and through several **puzzles**. The player can make **choices** that affect the outcomes of interactions and the **ending of the game** as well.

Characters are represented by **anthropomorphic animals**.

The game is represented through **text dialogue** and 2D digitally drawn high quality **images and small animations** of the characters.

1.2. Setting

The game takes place inside several rooms of a **simulated house inside of a research facility**

Locations: Bedroom, Living room, Kitchen, Bathroom, Research facility

1.3. Core Gameplay Loop

Solving puzzles and **making dialogue choices** that affect the outcome of the story.

2. Narrative

2.1. Chapter 1 "The puzzle"

A **detective** (protagonist character) is investigating a **case about missing people**. His search leads him to **Snatch** company when, suddenly, he **loses consciousness**.

He wakes up in an **unfamiliar bedroom** with no memory of how he got there. In the room he **notices the presence of a person** (victim character).

Before there could be any interaction between both, a **monitor in one of the walls turns on** and shows a **silhouette of a person** (mastermind character). The mysterious person starts to speak. They explain that both the investigator and the stranger are **trapped in the room** and if they want to get out they need to go through a **series of challenges**. Failing those challenges would result in a **punishment** being delivered. No more information is shared and the screen turns off.

2.2. Chapter 2 "Trifurcation"

Both the detective and the victim **start trusting** each other as they complete the challenges. They **start to share who they are** to each other and it's learned that **the stranger is actually the daughter of the CEO from the company the detective is investigating**.

Throughout the challenges, **evidence of crimes committed by the Snatch company is subtly given** to the entrapped duo. With the research from the detective, the inside knowledge from the daughter and the newly acquired evidence, they come to realize that **they are subjects of an underground research being done that experiments on people**.

At this point the **"culprit"** reveals their identity as one of the **many victims** of those experiments and **explains that the reason behind putting the detective and the daughter in this situation is for the three of them to work towards the termination of this research**.

2.3. Chapter 3 “Morals”

In the end **the trio publishes the information of the crimes** the company committed to the public.

3. Characters

3.1. The Detective (player character)

He/Him

In his **mid 40s**

Investigating the "Snatch" company

Male presenting, **gray wolf**, **rough and untreated fur** that starts to show wear and tear due to age. **Smokes (a pipe)** and has a **London 1850's fashion style**. Well dressed but unkempt.

Has a high **sense of morals**, believes he has a duty to protect the victims that are ignored by the defense system. Shows some **indications of depression** due to the nature of his job. Is **strict** and a **workaholic** but has a **soft spot for those he decides to protect**. Has been mostly by himself all his life.



Inspiration image of the detective character (game *Zenless Zone Zero*)

3.2. The Victim

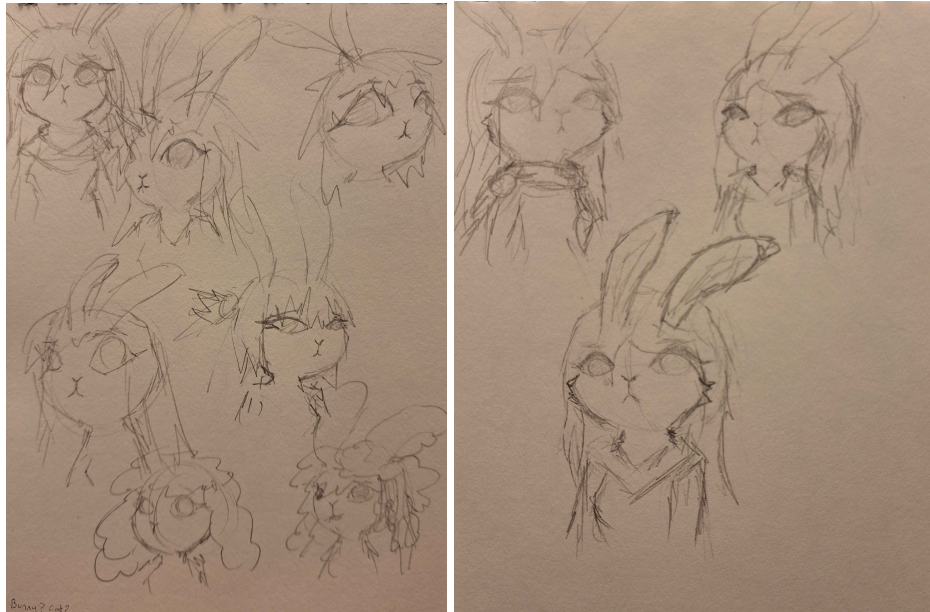
She/Her

In her **early 20s**

Daughter of the CEO of the *Snatch* company

Female presenting, **bunny**, dresses in a **private college uniform**, has **pure white smooth and well treated fur**.

Wants to trust but is not able. Makes themselves be perceived as **intimidating** but they are **afraid**. **Immature but knowledgeable**. **natural beauty** makes them feel less approachable and lacks social culture.



Sketches of the victim character

3.3. The Mastermind

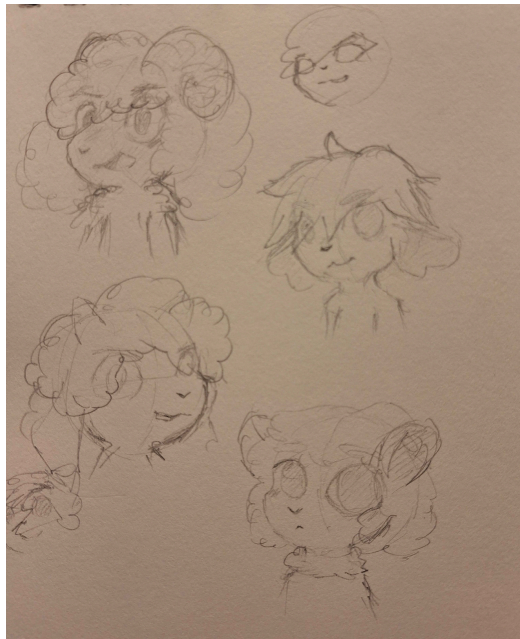
They/Them

Unknown age

Virtual representation of the victims of the experiments done by the "Triple Exes" company.

Androgynous presenting, **sheep**, **fluffy fur**, **childlike** appearance, **small**, dressed in an **oversized lab coat**.

Unpredictable and evasive. Heavily reliant on **satire**, **double-entendres** to avoid direct disclosure. A **hidden, targeted objective or grievance**. **Highly empathetic and altruistic**. The external **chaotic behavior** serves as a protective barrier for a fundamentally **self-sacrificing and protective nature**.



Sketches of the mastermind character

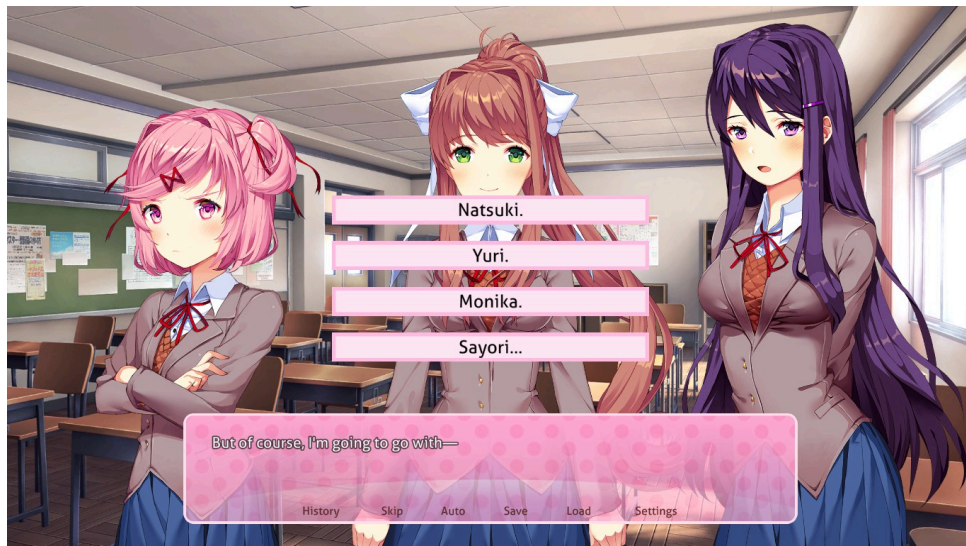
4. Gameplay Mechanics

4.1. Dialogue

The narrative is presented through **text** within the boundaries of a **dialogue textbox** that, when active, is located on the bottom of the screen. This textbox contains pieces of **narration** or **dialogue** between characters. Interacting with the textbox **skips** to the next piece of dialogue.

When a character is on scene, apart from their speech being represented in text, they are also represented by a **drawn image or animation** (usually hands or mouth are animated). When they are actively talking, they are **animated**. When a different character is talking, the images are **dimmed** to give importance to the active character instead.

During dialogue, the player can be **prompted to choose** between different options. These affect the **outcome of the interactions** and possibly the **ending** of the game.



Screenshot of the game *Doki Doki Literature Club*

4.2. Puzzles

There are several **small simple puzzles** that take place within certain situations to **break from the monotony** of purely reading. These puzzles fit within specific sections of the game and

narrative. Their outcome / score **affect the outcomes of the game flow.**

4.3. Narrative Paths

Depending on the **player's choices** and the **outcomes of puzzles**, the **flow of the narrative changes**. This leads to different interactions and reactions, and possibly a **different ending**.

5. Visual and Audio Style

5.1. Visual Style

2D hand-drawn style. Characters are represented as **anthropomorphic animals**. Inspired by the game *The Crown of Leaves*.

Characters - represented by a **dynamic image** of their body that covers from **head to waist**. This image is a still shot with the exception of the **mouth, which is animated** (when talking). Each character has **different facial and body expressions** to convey emotions.

Background - represented by a **single static image** that conveys the **current location** the characters are in.

UI - dialogue box that is located on the **bottom of the screen**; the **options button** that opens up the respective menu is located at the **top left of the screen**.



Games *Slay the Princess* (left) and *Crown of Leaves* (right)

5.2. Audio Style

Convey a sense of **mystery** and **suspense**.

Dialogue - when a character speaks, there is a **very quick sound** for **every single character** that is displayed on their textbox. This sound demonstrates, in an abstract way, the **voice of the character**.

Music - depending on the current environment there is music playing that helps to **convey the current mood**. In addition, the title screen has its own song that conveys the theme of the game.

Other sound effects - mouse clicking, minigame inputs, minigame ending should have a **satisfying sound**.

6. Monetization

The game will be available on itch.io and unityhub under the name of *Not Labeled* and will be displayed as a downloadable or in-browser **free-to-play** game with the option for the player to instead **pay an amount defined as they wish**.

The game will also be available as an **open-source project** on github.com under the **GNU General Public Licence**.

As the game is a university project, it benefits the creators that it is **readily available for reference and play** for interested parties. The fact that the game and its contents are open-source allows this option to be made easier.

7. Platform, Technology and Scope

Platform - **Web browser**, *Linux* and *Windows* PC (with the possibility of being ported for *Android* and *iOS* and maybe consoles if the scope allows).

Hardware Requirements - **Low** (to be tested), the game is not resource demanding.

Tools and Engines - *Unity*, *Krita*, *Audacity*, more to be defined.

Team Size - **Two members**.

Estimated Development Time - **10 weeks**.

No LLMs are / will be used.

8. Appendix

Github repository (includes project organization):

https://github.com/Teresa-Gamito/3rd_semester_project

Progress document:

 3rd semester project - organization

GNU General Public Licence:

<https://www.gnu.org/licenses/gpl-3.0.en.html>

References:

https://store.steampowered.com/app/604330/The_Crown_of_Leaves/

Gantt Chart:

<https://github.com/users/Teresa-Gamito/projects/1/views/4>